十一天不睡觉的少年

Eleven Days Without Sleep



十一天不睡觉，身体会怎样？

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

On 28 December 1963 Randy Gardner, a 17-year-old science enthusiast at a San Diego high school, set out to forgo slumber for a regional science fair. Two companions diligently jolted him awake whenever his alertness waned and logged his mood. The project, a voluntary endeavour, went on to take first place.

William Dement, a sleep researcher at Stanford, read press coverage of the attempt and was intrigued. He drove to San Diego and assisted John J. Ross, a Navy researcher, in monitoring the sleepless boy closely. The two investigators attentively noted the fluctuations in his state as the deprivation progressively deepened.

The consequences soon mounted. Gardner grew moody, lost concentration, and found his short-term memory impaired. He became suspicious, at times paranoid, and began to hallucinate. On the fourth day he was gripped by the delusion that he was a professional American football player.

Gardner ended the wearying attempt on 8 January 1964, after 264.4 hours, about 11 days and 25 minutes. He then slept soundly for about 14 hours and woke apparently refreshed. Researchers probed the case in a 1965 scholarly paper, which helped highlight microsleeps, involuntary lapses into sleep lasting a few seconds. Gardner may have had such momentary bouts without noticing.

In 1997 Guinness World Records discontinued monitoring such attempts because of the health perils, and others have since alleged longer stints awake. In a 2017 interview Gardner said severe insomnia had tormented him for about a decade, and he himself pinned the blame on the experiment. The boy who had seemed to bounce back from exhaustion with one long rest would, decades later, barely doze off.

中文译文

1963年12月28日，圣迭戈一所高中里，17岁的科学爱好者兰迪·加德纳为参加地区科学展，开始尝试不睡觉。每当他的清醒程度下降，两名同伴就尽力把他唤醒，并记录他的情绪。这项自愿开展的尝试后来获得了第一名。

斯坦福大学睡眠研究者威廉·德门特读到有关报道后产生了兴趣。他开车来到圣迭戈，协助海军研究员约翰·J.罗斯密切观察这名不眠的少年。随着缺觉程度逐步加重，两位研究者仔细记录着他状态的变化。

不良后果很快加剧。加德纳变得喜怒无常，注意力难以集中，短时记忆也受到损害。他开始多疑，有时甚至出现偏执妄想，还产生了幻觉。到第四天，他竟认定自己是一名职业美式橄榄球运动员。

1964年1月8日，加德纳结束了这场令人疲惫的挑战，历时264.4小时，约合11天零25分钟。之后，他酣睡约14小时，醒来时似乎恢复了精神。研究者在1965年的一篇学术论文中探讨了这个案例，使人们更加关注“微睡眠”：人会不由自主地短暂入睡，持续几秒钟。加德纳可能经历过这种短暂睡眠，自己却没有察觉。

1997年，吉尼斯世界纪录因健康风险停止监测此类挑战，此后仍有人声称自己保持清醒的时间更长。2017年接受采访时，加德纳说，严重失眠已折磨了自己约十年，他本人将其归咎于当年的实验。那个曾经看似睡个长觉便能从极度疲惫中恢复的少年，几十年后却几乎连打个盹都做不到。

晚年失眠与当年实验的因果关系，文中并未证实。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

enthusiast n.
爱好者
a 17-year-old science enthusiast

forgo v.
放弃；不享用
to forgo slumber

alertness n.
警觉；清醒程度
his alertness waned

wane v.
减弱；衰退
his alertness waned

voluntary adj.
自愿的
a voluntary endeavour

endeavour n.
尝试；努力
a voluntary endeavour

intrigue v.
使感兴趣
was intrigued

fluctuation n.
波动；变化
the fluctuations in his state

deprivation n.
剥夺；缺失
the deprivation progressively deepened

concentration n.
注意力；专注
lost concentration

impair v.
损害；使受损
short-term memory impaired

paranoid adj.
偏执多疑的；有妄想的
at times paranoid

hallucinate v.
产生幻觉
began to hallucinate

delusion n.
妄想；错误的确信
gripped by the delusion

involuntary adj.
不由自主的
involuntary lapses into sleep

discontinue v.
停止；终止
discontinued monitoring such attempts

peril n.
危险；风险
because of the health perils

insomnia n.
失眠
severe insomnia

torment v.
折磨；使痛苦
had tormented him for about a decade

pin the blame on 动词短语
把责任归咎于
pinned the blame on the experiment

bounce back from 动词短语
从……中迅速恢复
bounce back from exhaustion

exhaustion n.
精疲力竭
bounce back from exhaustion

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共36项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

slumber n.
睡眠

regional adj.
地区的；区域性的

companion n.
同伴

diligently adv.
尽心尽力地

jolt v.
使猛然惊醒

awake adj.
醒着的

mood n.
情绪

take first place 动词短语
获得第一名

coverage n.
新闻报道

assist v.
协助；帮助

in prep.
在……方面（assist…in）

sleepless adj.
不眠的；未睡的

closely adv.
密切地

investigator n.
研究者；调查人员

attentively adv.
专注地；仔细地

progressively adv.
逐步地；不断地

deepen v.
加深；加重

consequence n.
后果

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共36项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

mount v.
增加；加剧

moody adj.
喜怒无常的

short-term adj.
短期的；短时的

suspicious adj.
多疑的；猜疑的

be gripped by 动词短语
被强烈情绪或想法控制

wearying adj.
令人疲惫的

soundly adv.
（睡得）熟；酣畅地

refreshed adj.
恢复精神的

probe v.
深入探究

scholarly adj.
学术的

highlight v.
使受到关注；凸显

lapse into 动词短语
不由自主地陷入

momentary adj.
短暂的；瞬间的

bout n.
一阵；一段发作

allege v.
声称（尚未证实）

stint n.
一段时间

barely adv.
几乎不；勉强

doze off 动词短语
打瞌睡；短暂入睡

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 Two companions diligently jolted him awake whenever his _____ waned and logged his mood.

02 The project, a voluntary _____, went on to take first place.

03 Gardner grew moody, lost concentration, and found his short-term memory _____.

04 He became suspicious, at times paranoid, and began to _____.

文章主线

- 挑战 1963年底，17岁加德纳为科学展尝试不睡觉；同伴帮他保持清醒，睡眠研究者随后加入监测。
- 损害 他逐渐情绪不稳，注意力和短时记忆受损，出现多疑和幻觉，甚至以为自己是职业橄榄球员。
- 结束 264.4小时（约11天）后挑战结束；酣睡约14小时后，他醒来似乎恢复了精神。
- 疑点 他可能经历过未察觉的数秒微睡眠；吉尼斯1997年因健康风险停止记录此类挑战。
- 晚年 2017年，他说严重失眠已折磨自己约十年，并归咎于当年实验；文章没有证明这种因果关系。

参考答案　1 alertness 2 endeavour 3 impaired 4 hallucinate